

Header and Footer

Summary

The header/footer microservice is owned by a separate team and bundles search, sign-in, cart, analytics, and consent management. No authoring of header/footer content is required in EDS — only injection.

1. Current State Analysis

The current AEM production architecture uses Apache SSI (**Server-Side Includes**).

Microservice Endpoints

Endpoint	URL Pattern	Used By
Public	https://www.thermofisher.com/global-header-footer/header/nojquery	Apache SSI (production)
Public	https://www.thermofisher.com/global-header-footer/footer/nojquery	Apache SSI (production)
Internal	{gateway}/tf/header/{userType}/{lang}/{country}/noTrustArc.nojquery.shtml	Author/Preview only

The public endpoint returns a **single generic HTML blob** (~500KB) and consists of .

Component	Size
Inline CSS	~200KB
HTML	~50KB
Inline JS	~150KB
Country data	~100KB

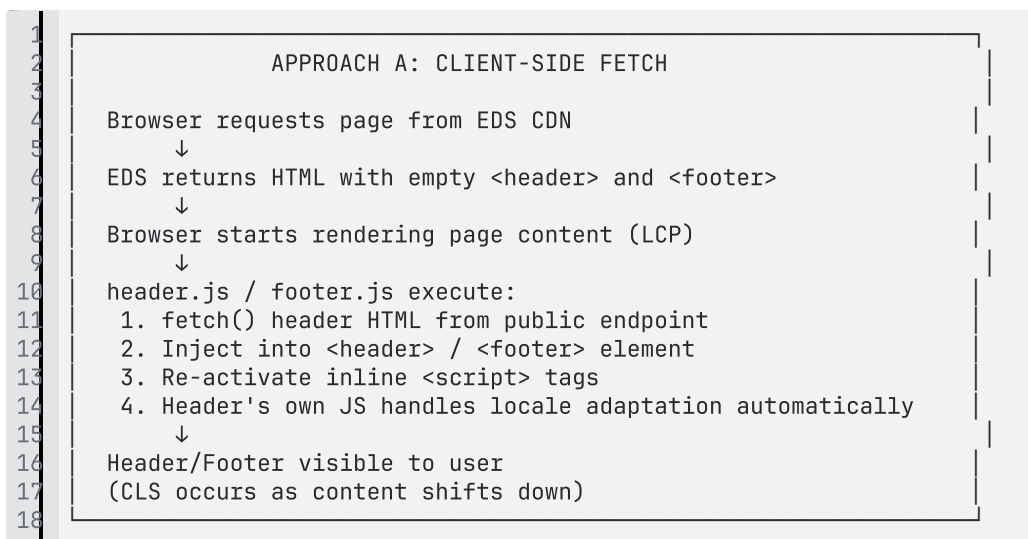
Adobe Launch	External
TrustArc	~50KB

2. EDS Integration

In EDS there are 2 approaches to Implement header

- a. Approach A: Client-Side Fetch
- b. Approach B: Edge Worker Injection

Approach A: Client-Side Fetch



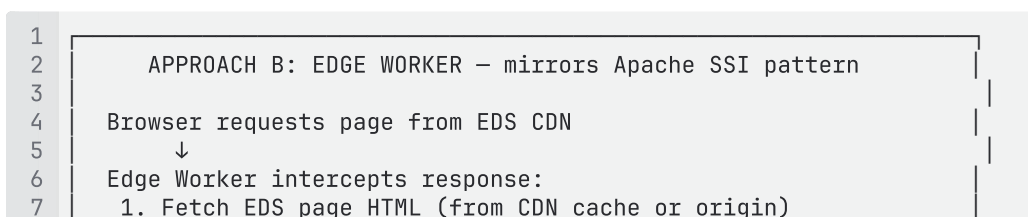
Pros:

- No edge infrastructure required
- Easy to debug (browser DevTools)

Cons:

- **CLS** — page renders, then header pushes content down
- **LCP impact** — +200-500ms before header is visible
- **SEO** — search engines may not see header content
- **Flash of unstyled content** — page loads without header, then it appears

Approach B: Edge Worker Injection



8	2. Fetch header HTML from public endpoint (from edge cache)
9	3. Fetch footer HTML from public endpoint (from edge cache)
10	4. Stitch: inject header + footer into page HTML
11	5. Return complete HTML to browser
12	↓
13	Browser receives FULL page with header + content + footer
14	No CLS, no extra fetch, SEO-friendly
15	

Pros:

- **Zero CLS** — header is in the HTML before browser parses it
- **SEO-friendly** — search engines see complete page
- **Mirrors current SSI pattern** — same cache separation architecture

Cons:

- Requires edge infrastructure setup
- Edge worker latency (~5-20ms) added to TTFB
- Header's ~500KB still impacts page weight

**** Approach B (Edge Worker)** is recommended

3. Assumptions

- All locale adaptation, search, cart, auth, analytics, and consent are handled by the header's own inline JavaScript — automatically, after the page loads in the browser.
- Header looks for cookie `CK_ISO_CODE`, `CK_LANG_CODE`, `identity_uid` to get country, language and usertype and loads header accordingly.
- In EDS, all userType personalization is handled client-side by the header's own JS.

4. Open Questions

- Confirm that does Edge worker need to call /global-header and /global-footer url for Microservice or userstate, language, countrycode need to be passed (is Microservice url will always be global path or will have lang, country and usertype, microservice url ?).
- Confirm that assumption is correct that for us/en all links will have us/en and for in/en al links will have in/en are handled by header.js .